

Microsoft completes US\$ 7.5 billion GitHub acquisition deal

Microsoft made an announcement that it has completed its US\$ 7.5 billion deal of acquiring GitHub, a process that began in June this year. GitHub is a leading



software development platform that brings together more than 31 million developers to create, collaborate, share and build on each other's work.

Nat Friedman, former CEO of Xamarin, which was acquired by

Microsoft in 2016, is taking over as GitHub's CEO, Microsoft said in a statement.

The news comes just a week after the European Commission approved the deal, ruling that the merged entity wouldn't pose any major concerns over competition. The commission's ruling stated: "The market investigation confirmed that Microsoft would not have the market power to undermine the open nature of GitHub to the detriment of competing DevOps tools and cloud services. This is because such behaviour would reduce the value of GitHub for developers, who are willing and able to switch to other platforms."

Microsoft's official statement read as follows: "GitHub will retain its developer-first ethos, operate independently, and remain an open platform. Together, the two companies will work together to empower developers to achieve more at every stage of the development life cycle, accelerate enterprise use of GitHub, and bring Microsoft's developer tools and services to new audiences."

In a blog post celebrating the news, Friedman highlighted the areas we can expect GitHub to focus on going forward: "We will start by focusing on the daily experience of using GitHub and will double down on our Paper Cuts project. We will improve core scenarios like search, notifications, issues/projects, and our mobile experience. And of course we are excited to make GitHub Actions broadly available."

Infosys releases enterprise-class DevOps platform

Infosys has launched an enterprise-class integrated open source DevOps platform, which helps in accelerating an organisation's Agile and DevOps transformation journey.

The platform helps enterprises in a number of ways. It rapidly onboards applications on Agile and DevOps through a self-service model. Enterprises can quickly scale through continuous integration, testing and delivery, thus reducing



application onboarding from months to days, with 2000+ prebuilt scripts and 150+ DevOps pipelines.

The platform also accelerates application delivery across enterprise portfolios with a tool-agnostic approach, through pre-configured pipelines across 25+

IBM buys Red Hat for US\$ 34 billion to stay ahead in the cloud race

IBM will be acquiring enterprise Linux-based solutions provider Red Hat for US\$ 34 billion.

"The acquisition of Red Hat is a game-changer," said IBM CEO Ginni Rometty. "IBM will become the world's No. 1 hybrid cloud provider, offering companies the only open cloud solution that will unlock the full value of the cloud for their businesses," Rometty added.

The hybrid cloud implies interlinked private/public clouds coupled to in-house data centres. IBM was once a prospective leader of the cloud market, but was left behind in the race when other cloud service providers like Amazon and Microsoft surged ahead. But with the Red Hat acquisition, IBM is back in the game, giving tough competition to its peers. Red Hat's share value has grown 170 per cent in the last five years.

Red Hat CEO Jim Whitehurst said, "Joining forces with IBM will provide us with a greater level of scale, resources and capabilities to accelerate the impact of open source as the basis for digital transformation and bring Red Hat to an even wider audience – all while preserving our unique culture and unwavering commitment to open source innovation."

Whitehurst and the current management team will continue to lead Red Hat, sources at IBM reported, retaining the Red Hat HQ and brands. IBM proposed an offer of US\$ 190 per issued and outstanding Red Hat share, which was approved; the current price is US\$ 116. Red Hat will be absorbed into IBM's Hybrid Cloud unit.

Both Red Hat and IBM are big supporters of Linux, contributing to the kernel and its surrounding software. IBM was among the big names in business that came to the Linux world's rescue when it was being menaced by patent trolls and Microsoft. IBM wants to transform itself into a hybrid cloud platform, rather than be seen eternally as a maintainer of legacy mainframes and databases.